

December

1

1988

HIV awareness

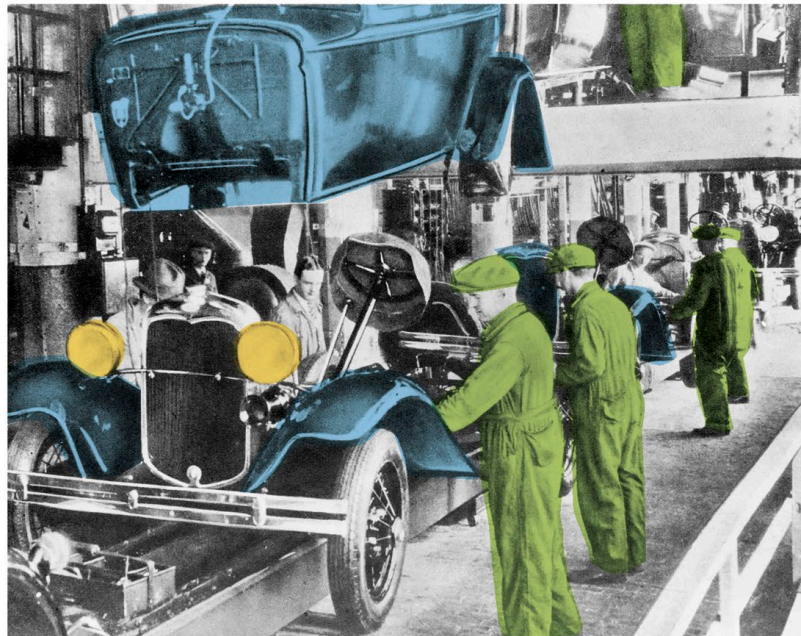
World AIDS Day was first established on this day to raise awareness of the millions of people living with HIV around the world. People wear a red ribbon on World AIDS Day each year to show their support.



1920

Straight off the line

The world's first moving assembly line in the car industry was introduced by US entrepreneur Henry Ford. This improvement slashed the time taken to make each Model T, so they became cheaper to produce, and therefore more affordable for ordinary families.



Bold boycott

1955

Black American activist Rosa Parks refused to give up her seat to a white passenger, and was arrested. Her protest led to the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the ban of racial segregation on US public buses.

Born this day

1761 Madame Tussaud, French artist. She made lifelike wax sculptures of famous people, and founded her own museum in 1835.

Also on this day

1640 The House of Bragança came into power in Portugal, ending the Iberian Union and 60 years of rule by the Spanish crown.

1959 Twelve countries signed the Antarctic Treaty, which banned military activity on the continent.

1990 Workers met midway under the English Channel as they dug the Channel Tunnel, which links the United Kingdom to France.